Fun with cryptography

Send secret messages, disguise your files and encrypt them

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PIXELOID

Pixeloid is a totally unique software when it comes to hiding text, an image, or a text file in its entirety. What Pixeloid does is that it takes the input, and converts it into an image file, that has a pixel arrangement derived from the input, and unique to that input. No matter what type of input is chosen, the output is always a 352x352 jpg image, with the number of squares increasing with the amount of text. For example, shown here is the simple image with only a few large tiles, that are the Pixeloid equivalent of "Hello There!". There is also a decryption mode available, where you can load a Pixeloid, and derive the original message or image. While encrypting text files users have the option of encrypting the contents of the text files, or choosing to allow Pixeloid to encrypt the file in its entirety, without actually reading the contents. Note that the feature for encrypting images is experimental, and does not work very well, the application may become unresponsive or take forever to complete a given task.

Converting text to images with Pixeloid

CRYPTO!

This is one of the many obscure tools you can use to send coded messages. The great thing is that the original tumblr page where it was hosted has been taken down, hasn't been cached by google and no snapshot on Wayback-machine so there are no instructions or details available, and it is highly unlikely anyone else will be using this tool. Still, at the end of the day it is a substitution cipher and these are pretty easy to work out using brute force methods or even by obsessive puzzle solvers given enough sample text using the same key. This is made easier by the fact that some of the context of longer text can be derived by the punctuation, which remains unchanged. This approach is most useful for short coded messages. The tool is needed to both generate the coded messages and to decipher encoded messages. There are two modes that the software operates in to do these two, "Encrypto!" and "Decrypto!". The toggle on the top switches between the two. The user keys in a message into the field, and can select a passkey. This is like a password, and the message will be revealed only if the correct key is provided, otherwise it remains gibberish. Note that you have to remember this key. The software keeps detailed logs of everything it does, which are available in the .evadi files in the /log subdirectory. The KeyMap file has all the passwords used, along with a list of pre-configured default passwords out of which one is chosen at random by the "I'm feeling lucky!" button. The enc_out has

Encoding a message with a key in Crypto!